



Above Wide, tumbling rice terraces cut into the steep sides of ravines surround Ubud



Above Young Balinese dancers in traditional costume at the annual Bali Arts Festival, which features dance, theater, and shadow puppetry

Three Days in Bali

Bali is spectacularly beautiful, so wherever you go, you'll be blessed with glorious sights. The island's relaxed and rural artistic retreat – Ubud – is a good place to start.

DAY ONE Visit **Ubud** to shop for crafts or browse the **Neka Art Museum**. After lunch, follow narrow paths across the paddy fields, or head to **Tirta Empul**, a 1,000-year-old Hindu water temple with eerie stone carvings. After dark, catch a *barong* dance performance.

DAY TWO Rise very early to see dolphins at **Lovina**. Follow them into the water around **Menjangan Island**'s coral reefs, or hike easy trails through forested **Bali Barat National Park** to see monkeys, deer, and endangered Bali starlings. Returning to **Ubud**, stop at roadside viewpoints for views of the volcano **Gunung Agung**.

DAY THREE Spend the day on the beach enjoying **Kuta**'s lively bar scene, relax at the quieter resort of **Nusa Dua** or catch world-beating surf at **Uluwatu**. Enjoy the sunset from clifftop **Pura Luhur** temple, then head to beachside **Jimbaran** for a seafood barbecue.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Bali's **international airport** (named the Ngurah Rai Airport, but commonly called Denpasar Airport) and its **sea port** are near the capital, Denpasar. The island is only 93 miles (150 km) wide; transport is by **bus**, **taxi**, or rental **car**.

WHERE TO STAY

Poppies Gang 2 (inexpensive) is a legendary street in Kuta with lots of clean, basic hostels. Ubud's **Desa Sanctuary** (moderate) features self-contained, traditional buildings with modern facilities in Bali's cultural center. www.sanctuarythevillage.com

Suluban Cliff Villa (expensive) pampers with superlative clifftop sea views from your bed. www.sulubancliffbali.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

www.balitourismboard.org